

Sound & Music Score

Everything the audience hears, act by act — what plays, how it is made, and the cue that starts and stops it. *Six Characters in Search of an Author* · Village Players, Lausanne · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi

LIVE PIANO

RADIO · wings

SUNG LIVE

CELLO DRONE

PIANO · offstage / recorded

WATER · live or recorded

RECORDED

SILENCE

The music, piece by piece

1. Erik Satie — *Gymnopédie No. 1*

LIVE PIANO

Act Two, the Setup — solo piano under the Step-Daughter's shower monologue, once through.
2. Weimar-cabaret vamp — suggested: Kurt Weill, *Bilbao Song* (half tempo), or a vamp on Mistinguett's *Mon Homme*

LIVE PIANO

Act Two, the Apparition — continuous under Madame Pace; reprised “in tatters” in the Substitution, ending on one held chord.
3. A single struck piano note

PIANO · offstage / recorded

Act Three, the Refusal — one note like a slap at “You can force him, sir.”
4. Arvo Pärt — *Spiegel im Spiegel* (opening phrase)

RECORDED

Act Three, the Fountain — the closing ten seconds, then blackout.
5. French chanson — suggested: Aznavour, *La Bohème* (or a scratchy Piaf — *La Vie en rose*, *Sous le ciel de Paris*)

RADIO · wings

Act One, the Rehearsal — a wings radio, low and crackling.
6. *Valentine* (Maurice Chevalier, 1925)

SUNG LIVE

Act One, the Arrival — sung and danced live by the Step-Daughter; a period café-concert number, cheeky and dated on purpose.

PIANO

The live pianist plays in **Act Two only**: Satie's *Gymnopédie No. 1*; the Weimar vamp (Weill / Mistinguett) and its tattered reprise; the single held chord at the curtain. In Act Three the piano is heard just once — one note, offstage or recorded. The *Spiegel im Spiegel* coda is recorded (piano and violin). Everything else the audience hears — the cello drone, the fountain water, the gunshot — is sound, not music.

Act One — The Family

Three colours across six parts: white working light for the Rehearsal; amber from the Arrival through the Son; deep red for the Bargain. No piano in this act.

PART I — THE REHEARSAL

RADIO · wings

An old French **chanson** on a small radio in the wings — crackling, low, domestic, as if the company forgot to turn it off. *Suggested*: Aznavour, *La Bohème* (low), or a scratchy Piaf record (*La Vie en rose*, *Sous le ciel de Paris*).

CUE

Plays under the whole rehearsal. **Cuts off** the instant the Door-keeper speaks.

PART II — THE ARRIVAL SUNG LIVE

No instrument — “the warmth is the score.” The only music is the Step-Daughter's own: she **sings and dances** *Valentine* (Chevalier, 1925), live — a period café-concert number, cheeky and dated on purpose.

CUE Her song during the dance, where the script places it. Otherwise the amber wash carries the act.

PART VI — THE BARGAIN SILENCE

No music. The silence under the deepening red is the texture.

CUE Held to the end of the act — the cue into Act Two is the *absence* of sound.

Act Two — The Theatre

A small upright piano sits stage-right on the lower floor, in view all act. The pianist is a credited performer (a fourth Player, in effect), plays from their seat, and does not speak. The shower is a single overhead column of light, used three times.

PART I — THE SETUP LIVE PIANO

Satie — *Gymnopédie No. 1*: slow, simple, repeated, child-haunted. Played once through, beneath the Step-Daughter's monologue alone in the shower.

CUE Begins as the shower falls on her. **Ends on her last line** — the Child-bundle set down, the revolver back in the coat.

PART II — THE APPARITION LIVE PIANO

A slow, sleazy **Weimar-shop vamp** — comic-cabaret — under Madame Pace's whole aria. *Suggested:* Kurt Weill, *Bilbao Song* at half tempo, or a vamp on Mistinguett's *Mon Homme*.

CUE Plays continuously from her entrance through the transaction. **Dies mid-bar** on the Mother's “You old devil. You murderess.”

PART III — THE SUBSTITUTION LIVE PIANO

Fragments of the Madame Pace vamp, **in tatters** — as if rehearsing the same tune badly — while the Leading Lady and Leading Man take the platform. Then a single held **piano chord**.

CUE Returns cautiously for the doubled scene. **Cuts out the moment the Mother's cry begins** and does not return; one chord held as the accidental curtain falls.

Act Three — The Question

Dark stage; the fountain basin lit from inside, pale blue; one bare bulb swinging over the Manager's table. The pianist's chair is empty — no live piano in this act.

PART I — THE TRAP CELLO DRONE

A single sustained **cello drone**, very low — one barely-varying note, felt rather than heard, giving the room a pulse. *Suggested:* a sustained low C, or a low organ pedal-tone.

CUE Under the whole philosophical stretch. **Dies** as the Step-Daughter cuts the Father with “His reality. He always knew exactly where to find me.”

PART II — THE REFUSAL

SILENCE

PIANO · offstage / recorded

Silence — only footsteps and breath. One exception: a **single sharp piano note**, like a slap (offstage or recorded — the pianist's seat is empty now).

CUE The note sounds as the Father seizes the Son at “You can force him, sir.” Then silence again.

PART III — THE FOUNTAIN

WATER · live or recorded

RECORDED

The **sound of water** — the fountain itself — and, at the very end, the opening phrase of **Arvo Pärt — *Spiegel im Spiegel*** (about ten seconds).

CUE Water enters at the start and stays, louder as the Step-Daughter nears the basin; **the gunshot is real, in real silence** (the water briefly stops). The Pärt opens after “To hell with it all.” and the Manager's exit — then the lights go.

*One rule over all of it: the score should be **felt, not heard** — the audience need not know they are being scored. The only musician on stage is the Act Two pianist; everything in Acts One and Three is the wings radio, a low recorded drone, the live (or recorded) fountain, an offstage note, and the Pärt coda. The cues above are fixed; the suggested tracks are taste.*